Shared renderings: the Mesopotamian flood corpus

Binding for all six projects in this folder. See `corpus.md` for the editing rule: project translators propose additions in their `project.md`, and the corpus coordinator merges them here.

Echo tags follow guidelines §6.4: [cognate], [equivalent], [divergence], [absent].
"Seed" entries were set before drafting (2026-10-16). Change one only with a note in the Changelog below, and then update every project that uses it.

1. Proper names

Our forms extend guidelines §6.5. Vocalize them at first occurrence in each text. In plain text, write them without niqqud.

Akkadian / Sumerian	Hebrew	Notes
Atra-ḫasīs (OB spelling *Atram-ḫasīs*)	אַתְרַחֲסִיס	First occurrence: note that the name means "exceedingly wise" (*atru* + *ḫasīsu*). The same epithet is in Gilg. XI 197.
Ūta-napišti	אוּתְנַפְּשְׁתִּי	First occurrence: note the common form אותנפישתים.
Ziusudra (Sum.) / Xisouthros (Gk.) / Seisithros (Abydenus)	זִיּוּסוּדְרָה / קְסִיסוּתְרוֹס / סֵיסִיתְרוֹס	
Enki (Atra-ḫasīs, Sumerian) / Ea (Gilg. XI)	אֶנְקִי / אֵאָה	Keep whichever name the text uses. Note at the first occurrence that they are the same god.
Ellil / Enlil (Sum.)	אֶנְלִיל	Akkadian reading is Ellil. Hebrew keeps the familiar form.
Anu / An (Sum.)	אָנוּ / אַן	
Nintu, Mami, Bēlet-ilī, Nin-ḫursaĝa, Aruru	נִינְתּוּ, מָמִי, בֵּלֶת־אִילִי, נִין־חֶרְסַגָּה, אֲרוּרוּ	They are one mother goddess under several names. Keep the name the text uses. *Bēlet-ilī* = "mistress of the gods": translate it in a note, not in the text.
Igigū	אִיגִיגִי	
Anunnakkū / Anunna	אֲנוּנָּכִי / אֲנוּנָּה	
Ninurta	נִינוּרְתָּה	
Ennugi	אֶנוּגִי	
Nusku	נוּסְכּוּ	
Kalkal	כַּלְכַּל	Enlil's doorkeeper.
Wê (the slain god; older reading "Wê-ila")	וֵא (+ apposition "אֵל")	eBL (after Moran, Alster, Krebernik): *Wê ila* = "Wê, a god". Changed 2026-10-16.
Namtar	נַמְתָּר	
Adad	אֲדַד	
Šullat and Ḫaniš	שׁוּלַּת וְחָנִישׁ	
Errakal	אֶרְכַּל	
Ištar	אִשְׁתַּר	

Akkadian / Sumerian	Hebrew	Notes
Šamaš / Utu (Sum.)	שַׁמַּשׁ / אוּתוּ	Not שָׁמֶשׁ: the god is not the sun noun.
Nisaba	נִיסָבָה	
Pāšittu ("the Obliterator")	פָּשִׁיטְתּוּ	Translate the meaning in a note.
Lamaštu	לַמַּשְׁתּוּ	
Šuruppak / Šurippak / Šuruppag (Sum.)	שׁוּרוּפַּךְ	
Ubār-Tutu	אוּבָּר־טוּטוּ	
Puzur-Ellil (boatman)	פּוּזוּר־אֶנְלִיל	
Ur-šanabi	אוּרְשַׁנַּבִּי	
Mount Nimuš	הַר נִימוּשׁ	
Dilmun	דִּלְמוּן	
Uruk	אוּרוּךְ	First occurrence: note that it is אֶרֶךְ (בראשית י׳).
Eridu, Bad-tibira, Larak, Sippar	אֶרִידוּ, בַּד־טִיבִּירָה, לָרַךְ, סִיפַּר	
Apsû	הָאַפְּסוּ	Ea/Enki's subterranean freshwater ocean. Not תְּהוֹם, which would be a false echo; note the comparison only in the apparatus.
Euphrates (*Purattu*) / Tigris (*Idiqlat*)	פְּרָת / חִדֶּקֶל	Biblical names [cognate] (בראשית ב׳:י״ד).
Kronos (Berossus)	קְרוֹנוֹס	Berossus's Greek name for Ea. Note it.

2. Formulas

Identical Akkadian gets identical Hebrew (guidelines §6.1).

Akkadian	Hebrew	Notes
X *pâšu īpuš(am)-ma iqabbi / izakkar(a) ana* Y (one SB line)	X פָּתַח אֶת פִּיו וְאָמַר, אֶל Y דִּבֵּר	
X *pīašu īpušam-ma / izzakkar ana* Y (two OB lines)	X / פָּתַח אֶת פִּיו וְדִבֵּר אֶל Y	
ana šâšū-ma izakkar(a) ana Y	Y דִּבֵּר אֵלָיו, אֶל	
mimmû šēri ina namāri	כְּשֶׁהֵאִיר אוֹר הַבֹּקֶר	Dawn formula (Gilg.).
kikkiš kikkiš igār igār / kikkišu šimē igāru ḫissas	גְּדֵר־קָנֶה, גְּדֵר־קָנֶה! קִיר, קִיר! / שִׁמְעוּ, גְּדֵר־קָנֶה! קִיר, הַקְשֵׁב!	Ea's address to the reed fence.
igāru šitammianni / kikkišu šuṣṣirī kala zikriya (OB)	קִיר, הַקְשֵׁב לִי! / גְּדֵר־קָנֶה, שְׁמֹר אֶת כָּל דְּבָרַי!	
uqur bīta bini eleppa (Gilg.) / *ubut bīta bini eleppa* (OB, Ark 4)	נְתֹץ בַּיִת, בְּנֵה סְפִינָה / הֲרֹס בַּיִת, בְּנֵה סְפִינָה	*naqāru* = נתץ; *abātu* = הרס. The verb differs because the Akkadian differs. Plain spelling: הרוס בית. In every version, a note gives Wasserman 2020's reading *upud* (*napādu*) "depart from the house" (הִפָּרֵד מִבַּיִת).
makkūra zēr-ma napišta bulliṭ	מְאַס בִּרְכוּשׁ וְהַחֲיֵה נֶפֶשׁ	*bulluṭu* ↔ (בראשית ו:יט–כ; ז:ג) לְהַחֲיֹת [equivalent]. *napištu* ↔ נֶפֶשׁ [cognate].
ilū iṣṣinū ēriša / ilū iṣṣinū ēriša ṭāba	הָאֱלִים הֵרִיחוּ אֶת רֵיחַ / הָאֱלִים הֵרִיחוּ אֶת הָרֵיחַ הַטּוֹב	↔ (בראשית ח:כא) וַיָּרַח יְהוָה אֶת רֵיחַ הַנִּיחֹחַ [equivalent]. *ṭābu* ↔ טוֹב [cognate].
ilū kīma zubbī / zumbī eli bēl niqê ipteḫrū	הָאֱלִים הִתְקַבְּצוּ כִּזְבוּבִים עַל בַּעַל הַזֶּבַח	*zubbu* ↔ זְבוּב [cognate].
šīmtu	גּוֹרָל	"Fate, what is decreed". *šīmat awīlūti* = גּוֹרַל הָאָדָם.

3. Key terms

Akkadian (Sumerian)	Hebrew	Tag	Notes
abūbu (Sum. *a-ma-ru*)	מַבּוּל	[equivalent]	Guidelines §6.7. In the first note for each text, mention *abūbu* as a mythical monster/weapon too.
elippu (Sum. *ĝiš-má*)	סְפִינָה	[divergence] with תֵּבָה	Never תֵּבָה. Other boat words: *makurru* = אֳנִיָּה; Greek: πλοῖον = סְפִינָה, σκάφος = כְּלִי־שַׁיִט, ναῦς = אֳנִיָּה.
kupru	כֹּפֶר	[cognate]	וְכָפַרְתָּ … בַּכֹּפֶר (ו:יד).
ittû / *iṭṭû* (crude bitumen)	חֵמָר	[cognate?]	Biblical חֵמָר (בראשית יא:ג; יד:י; שמות ב:ג). Etymology uncertain; mark [equivalent] unless a source supports cognacy.
qinnu	קֵן	[cognate]	Watch for it: קִנִּים תַּעֲשֶׂה אֶת הַתֵּבָה (ו:יד) is interpreted in the commentary. Record every occurrence in the parallels index.
napištu	נֶפֶשׁ (or "חַיִּים" when the sense demands; then note it)	[cognate]	
balāṭu D *bulluṭu*	הֶחֱיָה	[equivalent]	
awīlu	אָדָם	[equivalent]	אָדָם/אֲדָמָה wordplay is Hebrew, not Akkadian. Note it, don't create it.
awīlūtu	הָאֱנוֹשׁוּת		"Mankind" as an abstract collective.

Akkadian (Sumerian)	Hebrew	Tag	Notes
nišū	הָאֱנָשִׁים		"People", plural. In "the people multiplied" ↔ כִּי הֵחֵל הָאָדָם לָרֹב (ו:א) [equivalent].
ilu, pl. *ilū*; *iltu*	אֵל, אֵלִים; אֵלָה	[cognate]	Never אֱלֹהִים.
puḫru (*puḫur ilī*)	אֲסֵפָה (אֲסֵפַת הָאֵלִים)		Not עֵדָה (would echo עֲדַת אֵל, תהלים פב:א). Note the parallel in the apparatus.
ṭiṭṭu	טִיט	[cognate]	Man made of clay ↔ עָפָר מִן הָאֲדָמָה (ב:ז) [divergence]. Gilg. XI 135: mankind "turned to clay".
damu	דָּם	[cognate]	
šīru	בָּשָׂר	[equivalent] (cognate of שְׁאֵר)	
ṭēmu	By sense, always with a note naming *ṭēmu*: "discernment, mind" → טַעַם (1 Sam 25:33; Ps 119:66; idiom *šanû ṭēmu* = שָׁנָה טַעְמוֹ, 1 Sam 21:14); "report, information" → דַּעַת (Gilg. I 8; cf. בְּעֵל טָעֵם, Ezra 4:8); "state of affairs, news" → מַצָּב; "plan, decision" → עֵצָה	[cognate]	In Atra-ḫasīs I (the slain god "who had *ṭēmu*", from whose flesh came the *eṭemmu*) the pun must survive: / טַעַם אִטִּים.
eṭemmu (Sum. *gidim*)	אִט, pl. אִטִּים (Isa 19:3); a note gives "רוּחַ הַמֵּת"	[cognate / loan]	Always vocalize the singular אִט (unvocalized it reads "slowly").

Akkadian (Sumerian)	Hebrew	Tag	Notes
rigmu	שְׁאוֹן (of people, the land, animals, the flood; pl. שְׁאוֹנִים); קוֹל (of a god's voice, Adad's thunder, or one person's cry, with a note that it is the "noise" word)		The reason for the flood in Atra-ḫasīs ↔ חָמָס (יא:ו, יג) [divergence].
ḫubūru	הֲמֻלָּה		
šamû	שָׁמַיִם	[cognate]	
erṣetu	אֶרֶץ	[cognate]	Also "netherworld"; note when it is.
mātu	אֶרֶץ	[equivalent]	The annotated file shows which Akkadian word stands behind אֶרֶץ.
tâmtu / tiāmtu	יָם		Cognate of תְּהוֹם [cognate]: note it in the apparatus, don't render it תְּהוֹם in the text.
mīlu	גֵּאוּת		High water, a flood of the river. Not the deluge.
meḫû	סוּפָה		
šāru	רוּחַ	[cognate?] [equivalent]	↔ (ח:א) וַיַּעֲבֵר אֱלֹהִים רוּחַ.
ūmu	יוֹם" when it means storm (with a note); סְעָרָה"	[cognate]	
mūšu	לַיְלָה		
summatu	יוֹנָה	[equivalent]	
sinuntu	סְנוּנִית		
āribu	עוֹרֵב	[cognate]	

Akkadian (Sumerian)	Hebrew	Tag	Notes
niqû	זֶבַח	[equivalent]	Gen 8:20 has עוֹלֹת. Mark [divergence] where relevant.
qutrinnu	קְטֹרֶת	[cognate]	
erēnu	אֶרֶז	[cognate]	
nīš ilī / *tamû* / *māmītu*	שְׁבוּעָה, נִשְׁבַּע		
pirištu	סוֹד		
amātu / *awātu*	דָּבָר		
zikru	שֵׁם / דִּבּוּר (by context)		
libbu	לֵב	[cognate]	
karāšu	כְּלָיוֹן		Destruction, catastrophe (*ana karāši*).
bāb / *bābu* (of the boat)	דֶּלֶת / פֶּתַח	[divergence]	↔ וּפֶתַח הַתֵּבָה בְּצִדָּהּ תָּשִׂים (ו:טז).
nappašu / *aptu* (vent, window)	חַלּוֹן / פֶּתַח־אֵיר	[equivalent]	↔ צֹהַר (ו:טז), חַלּוֹן הַתֵּבָה (ח:ו). Record in the parallels index.
kibrāti / *tubuqāti*	קְצוֹת הָאָרֶץ / פִּנּוֹת		

3a. Added after the first drafts (2026-10-16, merged from the projects' proposals)

Original	Hebrew	Tag	Notes
lullû	לַוְדְמוֹן		Must differ from *awīlu* = אָדָם (Atr. I 183 has both).
banû	בָּנָה	[cognate]	Of creating man too (cf. ב:כב). Not יָצַר / בָּרָא.
eṣēru, *uṣurtu*	צָר, צוּרָה	[cognate of יצר]	Corpus-wide, including the boat's plan (Gilg. XI 60, Ark 6–7, W).
balālu	בָּלַל	[cognate]	↔ יא:ט.
ṭabāḫu	טָבַח	[cognate]	
Bēlet-kala-ilī	גְּבֶרֶת־כָּל־הָאֵלִים		Translated in the text only in the naming line (Atr. I 243–244).
šapattu	כֵּסֶה		The full-moon day (Ps 81:4). Note *šapattu* / שַׁבָּת.
ittu	אוֹת	[cognate]	
andurāru; *ullu*	דְּרוֹר; עֹל	[cognate]	
ḫupšu	חֲבוּרַת הָעֲמֵלִים		**False friend** of חָפְשִׁי.
sekēru N	נִסְכַּר	[cognate]	↔ (ח:ב) וַיִּסָּכְרוּ, the same stem.
kalû (of the flood)	כָּלָא	[cognate]	↔ (ח:ב) וַיִּכָּלֵא הַגֶּשֶׁם.
nâḫu	נָח	[cognate]	↔ (ח:ד) וַתָּנַח. Keep נח for *nâḫu* only.
nagbu	מַעֲמַקִּים		Not מַעְיָנוֹת / תְּהוֹם.
zunnu / *rādu*	גֶּשֶׁם / זֶרֶם		
laḫmu	שְׁעִירִים		Ea's attendants.
guzalû	נוֹשֵׂא הַכִּסֵּא		Gilg. XI 101 = Atr. II H 24.
tarkullu; *nasāḫu*	עַמּוּדֵי הַקְּשִׁירָה; נָסַח	[cognate] (*nasāḫu*)	Gilg. XI 102 = Atr. II H 22.
gamertu	כָּלָה		Distinct from *karāšu* = כְּלָיוֹן.

Original	Hebrew	Tag	Notes
ūm warḫim; *rēš warḫi*	יוֹם הַיָּרֵחַ; רֹאשׁ הַיָּרֵחַ	[cognate]	
têrtu	צַו (a god's instruction); הוֹדָעָה (a message brought by messengers)		
kabātu + *rigmu* (*iktabta rigim awīlūti*)	כָּבֵד (עָלַי) שְׁאוֹן הָאֱנוֹשׁוּת		(עָלַי) in parentheses: it is not in the Akkadian.
šakānu + *abūbu*	חוֹלֵל (מַבּוּל)		Not הֵבִיא, which would echo ו:יז.
malāku Gt	נִמְלַךְ	[cognate]	Neh 5:7.
bābu	שַׁעַר (a house, a city); פֶּתַח (the boat)		
pītu	מִפְתָּח		Kept apart from *bābu*.
surqinnu / *qutrinnu*	מִנְחָה / קְטֹרֶת		
ṭiṭṭu + *târu*	נָהְפַּךְ לְטִיט		
šār (ŠÁR, 3,600)	שְׁאָר		With a note giving the number.
nindanu; *ikû*	קָנֶה (measure); אִיקּוּ		
nišū + suffix	אֲנָשַׁי, אֱנָשֶׁיהָ		
tenēšētu	בְּנֵי הָאֱנוֹשׁ		
ḫayyaltu / *ālittu* / *lā ālittu*	אִשָּׁה בְּחִילֶהָ / יוֹלֶדֶת / לֹא יוֹלֶדֶת		Not עֲקָרָה.
manzāzu	מְקוֹם עֲמִידָה		Not (ח:ט) מָנוֹחַ.
nammaššû	הַנָּע		**Not** רָמָשׁ. The words are not cognate, and רָמָשׁ would create the echo of ז:ח–ט exactly where the versions are compared.
šanā (distributive "two each")	שְׁנַיִם שְׁנַיִם	[cognate]	Ark 52.

Original	Hebrew	Tag	Notes
kīdu / *qerbu*	קֶרֶב / חוּץ	[cognate] (*qerbu*)	"Inside and outside" (Ark 18–19) ↔ (ו:יד) מִבַּיִת וּמִחוּץ [equivalent].
ṣulūlu / *ṣullulu*	קוֹרָה / קֵרָה		One root, as in the Akkadian.
šapāku / *tabāku*	שָׁפַךְ [cognate] / יָצַק (a liquid), צָבַר (solids heaped up, e.g. Gilg. XI 160)		
šikaru / *sīrāšu*	שֵׂכָר [cognate] / סֹבֶא		
kūm / *ammaku*	תַּחַת / בִּמְקוֹם אֲשֶׁר / אֲשֶׁר		
sunqu / *ḫušaḫḫu*	רָעָב / כָּפָן		
qâlu	הֶאֱזִין		Kept apart from *šemû*/*šitammû* (שָׁמַע/הִקְשִׁיב).
naṣāru; *nāṣirat napištim*	נָצַר; נוֹצֶרֶת נָפֶשׁ		The boat's name.
kamāsu (gather in)	אָסַף		כִּנֵּס = *paḫāru* D.
puluḫtu / *pulḫītu*	פַּחַד / אֵימָה		
eṭûtu / *daʾāmu* / *ekēlu* / *daʾummatu*	עֶלָטָה / הֶאֱפִיל / הֶחְשִׁיךְ / אֲפֵלָה		
zubbu = *zumbu*	זְבוּב	[cognate]	
apkallu (Sum. abgal)	חָכָם		Not גִּבּוֹר / נְפִילִים.
ummânu	אֻמָּן	[cognate of אָמוֹן]	*mārī ummânī* = בְּנֵי הָאֻמָּנִים.
ḫasīsu (Sum. ĝeštug₂)	תְּבוּנָה; נָבוֹן		First note on Atra-ḫasīs: "רַב־תְּבוּנָה".
libittu	לְבֵנָה	[cognate]	
lām abūbi	לִפְנֵי הַמַּבּוּל		
Sum. *a-ma-ru ba-ur₃*; *eĝer a-ma-ru ba-ur₃-ra-ta*	הַמַּבּוּל שָׁטַף; אַחֲרֵי שֶׁשָּׁטַף הַמַּבּוּל	[equivalent]	↔ (ט:כח) אַחַר הַמַּבּוּל. One form in every Sumerian text.

Original	Hebrew	Tag	Notes
Sum. *nam-lugal an-ta ed$_3$-de$_3$-a-ba*	כַּאֲשֶׁר יֻרְדָה הַמַּלְכוּת מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם		
Sum. *nam-lu$_2$-ulu$_3$*; *uĝ$_3$*; *numun nam-lu$_2$-ulu$_3$*	הָאֱנוֹשׁוּת; הָאֲנָשִׁים; זֶרַע הָאֱנוֹשׁוּת		
ṣalmāt qaqqadi / Sum. *saĝ gig$_2$-ga*	שְׁחוֹרֵי הָרֹאשׁ		
Sum. *ud-ba* / Akk. *ina ūmīšu*	בָּעֵת הַהִיא		Avoid בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם unless the original has "days" (*ina ūmī ullûti* = ד:ו ↔ בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם, [equivalent]).
Sum. *giri$_{17}$ ki su-ub* / Akk. *labān appi*	הִשְׁתַּחֲוָה, אַפּוֹ אַרְצָה		
Sum. *nam tar*	גּוֹרָלוֹ נִגְזַר		*šīmtu* = גּוֹרָל.
Sum. *edin*	עֲרָבָה		Never עֵדֶן (false echo).
Greek κατακλυσμός, Latin *diluvium*	מַבּוּל	[equivalent]	The LXX translates מַבּוּל with κατακλυσμός.
Greek ἄσφαλτος	כֹּפֶר		The LXX equates them (ו:יד).
Greek ἀφίημι (birds); Akk. *wuššuru*	שִׁלַּח	[equivalent]	
Greek ὄρνεα	עוֹפוֹת		
Greek πηλός	טִיט		
Greek κυβερνήτης; Akk. *malāḫu*	הַמַּלָּח; הַקַּבָּרְנִיט [cognate]		Different words, different Hebrew.
Greek Χαλδαῖοι	כַּשְׂדִּים		
Greek Ἡλίου πόλις	עִיר הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ		Common noun שֶׁמֶשׁ. The god is שַׁמַּשׁ.

New names: Inana = אִינַנָּה; Nintur = נִינְתּוּר; Nudimmud = נוּדִימּוּד; Pabilsaĝ = פַּבְּילְסַג; Sud = סוּד; Ki-ur = קִי־אוּר; Šakkan = שַׁכַּן; Alulim = אָלוּלִים; Utu's epithet *šul* = הָעֶלֶם (not גִּבּוֹר). Sumerian city forms: Zimbir = סִיפַּר, Larag = לָרַךְ, Eridug = אֶרִידוּ, Šuruppag = שׁוּרוּפַּךְ. Greek: Daisios = דַּיְסִיוֹס;

Armenia = אַרְמֶנְיָה; Kordyaeans = הַקּוֹרְדוּאִים; Otiartes / Ardates = (= אוּבָּר־טוּטוּ) אַרְדָּטֵס / אוֹטְיאַרְטֵס.

Formulas:

- SB speech formula over two lines: `X פְּתַח אֶת פִּיו וְאֶמַר, / דַּבֵּר אֶל Y:`. The OB two-line form stays `... / וְדַבֵּר אֶל Y`.
- *nappašu*: keep "פתחתי פתח־אוויר". `פָּתַח־אֲוִיר` is acceptable.

4. Register reminders specific to the corpus

- Sumerian and Greek texts use the same Hebrew for the same concept: the Sumerian *a-ma-ru* = `מַבּוּל`, the boat = `סְפִינָה`, and so on. Berossus's Greek πλοῖον = `סְפִינָה`, while σκάφος and λάρναξ get their own rendering with a note.
- **Speech:** the gods' speech is formal and short, so keep it so. Don't add emotion words that aren't in the Akkadian.

Changelog

- 2026-10-16: seed table written before drafting.
- 2026-10-16: merged the proposals of all six projects (§3a). Changed: the slain god's name (`וָא`), the *ubut* row, the *ṭēmu* senses, the *rigmu* scope, the boat words. Rejected: `רָמָשׁ` for *nammaššû* (replaced by `הַנָּע`), `שְׁרָטֵט` for *eṣēru*, `סָחַף` in the "after the flood" formula (replaced by `שָׁטַף`), `אֶשְׁנַב־אֲוִיר`.